

Wednesday, 2 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Light rain 20° 15°	MANCHESTER Rain 20° 15°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 17° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK's long-term borrowing costs have hit their highest level since 1998, putting fresh pressure on the government ahead of October's Budget.

This significant rise means it will be more expensive for the government to borrow money, potentially impacting public spending and economic plans. It's a key indicator of the financial challenges facing the country.

ECONOMY · UK
- 2

Former Prime Minister Keir Starmer has announced he is stepping down as an MP, triggering a by-election in his London constituency.

This surprise move will create a vacancy in a prominent seat and set the stage for a new political contest. It marks a significant moment for the Labour Party and the wider political landscape.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

Summer 2026 has officially been declared the UK's hottest on record, according to new figures from the Met Office.

This unprecedented summer has broken the previous record, set just last year in 2025, highlighting a continuing trend of rising temperatures. It's certainly been a memorable few months for the weather across Britain.

WEATHER · UK
- 4

Police have confirmed that a baby girl found dead at a property in Sheffield was stabbed.

This tragic development comes as authorities continue their investigation into the circumstances surrounding her death. It's a truly heartbreaking story that has shocked the community.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Spaces in male prisons across England and Wales have fallen to their lowest level this year, as jails near maximum capacity.

The Justice Secretary is preparing to give more details in the Commons on an early-release scheme to free inmates. This situation highlights the ongoing challenges facing the prison system.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

1 **Star Trek fans are aiming to break a world record for the largest Vulcan salute at the Science Museum on Star Trek Day.**

It's a fantastic way for Trekkies to celebrate the iconic franchise and its enduring legacy. Expect plenty of 'live long and prosper' wishes!

ON AIR – Are you a Star Trek fan, and if so, what's your favourite Star Trek moment or character?

EVENT · THIS WEEK

2 **A beloved star from the medical drama Casualty is set to lead the show's 40th anniversary special this September.**

The BBC medical drama will mark the milestone with a two-part story, promising plenty of drama and nostalgia for long-time viewers. It's a huge achievement for any TV show to reach 40 years!

ON AIR – Do you still watch Casualty, and who is your all-time favourite character from the show?

TV · COMING UP

3 **Victoria Beckham's fashion and beauty company has made its first profit after 18 years in business.**

The brand reported a £7.3 million operating profit, a significant turnaround after years of losses. It seems Posh Spice's business empire is finally thriving!

ON AIR – Are you surprised it's taken so long for Victoria Beckham's company to turn a profit, or is that just the reality of the fashion world?

BUSINESS · NOW

4 **A festival honouring the late Dolly Parton is set to take place in both Nashville and London.**

DollyFest will serve as a public memorial for the beloved artist, fulfilling her wishes. It's a wonderful way for fans on both sides of the Atlantic to celebrate her incredible life and music.

ON AIR – If you could pick one Dolly Parton song to be played at DollyFest, which one would it be and why?

MUSIC · COMING UP

5 **A noughties garage track has been named TikTok's UK song of the summer, bringing a classic back into the spotlight.**

Kyla's 2008 track 'Do You Mind' gained worldwide recognition in 2016 after being sampled by Drake. It just goes to show how popular older tunes can become again!

ON AIR – What's your favourite throwback track that you've seen make a comeback recently?

MUSIC · NOW

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City have reportedly agreed a British transfer record fee of £125 million for Chelsea midfielder Enzo Fernandez.**

This potential move would be a massive statement of intent from City and a huge fee for the Argentine star. It's the kind of deal that could reshape the Premier League title race.

ON AIR – Do you think any player is truly worth £125 million, or have transfer fees just gone completely mad?
FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Newcastle United have bolstered their squad, signing Belgium forward Matias Fernandez-Pardo from Lille for an initial £51.4 million.**

This significant investment shows Newcastle's ambition as they continue to build a competitive team. It'll be interesting to see how he performs in the Premier League.

ON AIR – Are Newcastle now serious contenders for a top-four spot, or do they still need more signings?
FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Katie Taylor is preparing for a stern test this Saturday night, rather than a testimonial, as she seeks to sign off her career in style.**

She faces Flora Pili in what promises to be a challenging fight at Croke Park. It's a huge moment for the boxing legend.

ON AIR – What's your favourite memory of watching Katie Taylor in the ring?
BOXING · UK

4 **Bukayo Saka's second-half goal was enough to earn Premier League champions Arsenal a hard-fought victory at Aston Villa.**

It was a crucial win for Arsenal as they continue their title defence. Villa made them work for it, but the champions showed their quality.

ON AIR – Are Arsenal looking like strong title contenders again this season, or is it too early to tell?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Defending US Open champion Carlos Alcaraz has cruised into the second round after returning from a four-month injury lay-off.**

He beat Russia's Roman Safiullin in straight sets, showing no signs of rust. It's a strong start for the young Spaniard as he aims to defend his title.

ON AIR – Do you think Alcaraz can go all the way and win the US Open again this year, or will someone else challenge him?
TENNIS · GLOBAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the sound of rainfall can significantly improve concentration and reduce stress.**
Researchers found that the gentle, consistent rhythm of rain acts as a natural white noise, helping to mask distracting sounds and create a more focused environment for work or relaxation.
- 2 The humble act of 'doodling' during meetings or phone calls is being hailed as a creativity booster.**
Far from being a sign of inattention, experts suggest that allowing your mind to wander creatively can help process information better and even spark new ideas.
- 3 More people are embracing the soothing hobby of 'collecting interesting pebbles and stones' from beaches and rivers.**
It's a simple pleasure, connecting with nature, and finding unique shapes and colours to bring a bit of the outdoors inside.
- 4 The joy of 'writing a physical letter' to a friend or family member is seeing a charming resurgence.**
In an age of instant messages, the thoughtful effort and anticipation of a handwritten note offer a unique and personal connection that many are rediscovering.
- 5 Scientists have found that looking at the colour green can literally make you feel more optimistic.**
Exposure to green hues is linked to feelings of growth, harmony, and freshness, subtly boosting mood and encouraging a positive outlook.
- 6 The trend for 'upcycling old denim' into new accessories like bags or home decor is gaining stylish momentum.**
It's a fantastic way to give beloved jeans a second life, combining sustainability with creative flair, and results in some truly unique pieces.
- 7 A recent study suggests that 'humming a tune' can be a surprisingly effective way to calm nerves and improve breathing.**
The gentle vibrations created by humming have a subtle soothing effect on the body, making it a simple tool for everyday well-being.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE DRY TEA LEAVES A LITTLE SNIFF AND A SILENT 'HMMM'.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of freshly brewed coffee, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: CHECKING THE REFLECTION IN THE SURFACE OF THE COFFEE, JUST TO SEE IF IT LOOKS 'RIGHT'.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a 'particular place' just has a really unique or special atmosphere that you absolutely love?

Whether it's a tiny bookshop, a bustling market, or a quiet park bench, what's a place that just 'feels' right to you, and why?

- We all have those 'little everyday pleasures' that might seem insignificant to others, but bring us immense joy, don't we?

What's a small, simple thing that consistently brightens your day, even if it's just watching the postman, or the perfect cup of tea?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is actually called a 'business'? Imagine trying to hold a business meeting with them!

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of snails is a 'trail', named for the distinctive marks they leave behind them.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils, meaning a pot of honey found in an ancient Egyptian tomb is still perfectly edible.
- The inventor of the frisbee was cremated and his ashes were moulded into frisbees after his death.
- The shortest war in history lasted only 38 to 45 minutes, fought between Britain and Zanzibar in 1896.
- Butterflies have about 12,000 eyes, though each one is very small.
- Penguins are the only birds that can't fly but can swim.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles, Ben Nevis, receives an average of 261 days of rain a year.
- Before erasers, people used stale bread to rub out pencil marks.
- The 'king' of a chess set can only move one square at a time in any direction.

On this day

Day 245 of the year, 120 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepshimas of Hnaita and companions (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Agricola of Avignon; Christian feast day: Antoninus of Pamiers; Christian feast day: Brocard. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1997 — 645AR, American rapper
- 1967 — Frank Fontseré, American drummer and songwriter
- 1992 — Ella Toone, English footballer
- 1966 — Dino Cazares, American guitarist, songwriter, and producer
- 1982 — Mark Phillips, English footballer
- 1977 — Sam Rivers, American musician (died 2025)
- 1969 — K-Ci, American R&B singer-songwriter
- 1981 — Chris Tremlett, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 2008 — Google launches its Google Chrome web browser.
- 1968 — Operation OAU begins during the Nigerian Civil War.
- 1985 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politicians and former MPs M. Alalasundaram and V. Dharmalingam are shot dead.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1984 — Seven people are shot and killed and 12 wounded in the Milperra massacre, a shootout between the rival motorcycle gangs Bandidos and Comancheros in Sydney, Australia.
- 2022 — Eighteen people are killed and 23 others are injured by a suicide bombing at a Sunni mosque in Herat, Afghanistan.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2024 — At least 129 inmates are killed and 59 more injured in an attempted prison break at Makala Prison in Kinshasa, Democratic Republic of the Congo.
- 1970 — NASA announces the cancellation of two Apollo missions to the Moon, Apollo 15 (the designation is re-used by a later mission), and Apollo 19.

- 1970 — Aeroflot Flight 3630, a Tupolev Tu-124 en route from southern Russia to Lithuania, crashes after the pilots lost control of the aircraft at cruise altitude between Rostov-on-Don Airport and Vilnius Airport, on the second leg of the flight; all 37 passengers and crew are killed.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 246 of the year, 119 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Bartholomew Gutierrez; Christian feast day: Blessed Brigida Morello Zancano; Christian feast day: Mansuetus of Toul; Christian feast day: Marinus. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1992 — August Alsina, American singer-songwriter
- 1956 — Stephen Woolley, English director and producer
- 1978 — John Curtis, English footballer
- 1982 — Andrew McMahon, American singer-songwriter, pianist, and producer
- 1938 — Sarah Bradford, English historian and author
- 1925 — Anne Jackson, American actress (died 2016)
- 1948 — Don Brewer, American drummer and singer-songwriter
- 2000 — Brandon Williams, English footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1989 — Varig Flight 254 crashes in the Amazon rainforest near São José do Xingu in Brazil, killing 12.
- 1976 — Viking program: The American Viking 2 spacecraft lands at Utopia Planitia on Mars.
- 1945 — A three-day celebration begins in China, following the Victory over Japan Day on September 2.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1944 — Holocaust: Diarist Anne Frank and her family are placed on the last transport train from the Westerbork transit camp to the Auschwitz concentration camp, arriving three days later.
- 1989 — Cubana de Aviación Flight 9046 crashes into a residential area of Havana shortly after takeoff from José Martí International Airport, killing 150.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar